

## Select Board Advances Community Center Project Con't

In December 2024, the Select Board voted to delay the Community Center project for at least six months, targeting no earlier than the Fall 2025 Town Meeting for a Phase 1 (which included the front portion of the first floor only) funding request. The delay was also intended to accommodate temporary library operations within the building during the library renovation project.

The Library currently anticipates vacating the lower level of the Community Center building in September 2026. This anticipated transition creates an important opportunity for the Town to determine next steps for construction sequencing, occupancy planning, and project mobilization.

Leading up to the June 9, 2026, vote, the Select Board discussed the project and timeline at its meetings on May 12, 2026, and May 26, 2026.

### Community Center Project: Plans, Progress & Updates

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## Select Board Reviews Community Center Proposed Funding

In its review of the project, the Select Board discussed how this project fits into the Town's Capital Plan and the possible use of alternative funding sources to offset additional debt. The Board specifically considered the following funding opportunities:

- Del Webb Chauncy Lake Stabilization Fund (\$2.5M) – This fund is the result of a variance approved by the Zoning Board of Appeals for the Del Webb residential project. The decision specifically points to affordable housing or support of seniors as the appropriate uses of these funds. If the funds were split between the two uses, approximately \$1.5M will be available as a potential funding source for this project.
- Regal Settlement Funds (\$1.6M) – These funds were FY2026 General Fund Revenues that will be available from Free Cash.
- Sale of Senior Center Property (\$2.9M) – These funds would not be immediately available. Since the Senior Center cannot be sold until the project is complete, the Town could ask Town Meeting to use the proceeds to offset the project debt. The property is currently assessed for approximately \$2.9M but an appraisal will be done closer to the time the Town considers selling. This would need to be sold under Massachusetts Procurement Laws.
- General Fund Debt – Any costs not covered by alternative funding sources would need to be borrowed.
- Westborough Community Center Foundation – a citizen-led fundraising group that could contribute private donations, though the scale and certainty of that funding is not defined yet.

The Board reviewed debt projections and capital plan impacts using earlier estimates, but no final costs are known due to changes in scope and inflation.

## Project Funds Appropriated to Date:

| Funding Source                           | Approved by                                               | Appropriation | Purpose                                                      |                                                |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| ARPA Funds                               | Select Board as recommended by Advisory Finance Committee | \$40,000      | Owner's Project Manager                                      | Approximately<br><b>\$250,000</b><br>remaining |
| Free Cash                                | STM 2023 Town Meeting                                     | \$85,000      | Public Engagement and Schematic Design                       |                                                |
| Del Webb Chauncy Lake Stabilization Fund | STM 2024 Town Meeting                                     | \$1,131,413   | Phase 1: Design/Bid Documents<br>Phase 2: Design Development |                                                |